

SAI TEJA PASULA

(765) 775-0913 • saitejapasula@gmail.com • linkedin.com/in/pst1320 • saiteja-2811.github.io

PROFILE

- Data Science Manager with 7+ years of experience leading teams in **Causal Inference** and **Personalization Analytics**. Delivered **\$120M+** incremental revenue impact by scaling production-grade ML on Google Cloud Platform. Expert in mentoring scientists, Product Roadmap development, and building AI solutions for enterprise-level ROI.
- **Machine Learning & Statistics:** Causal ML (Double ML, Uplift), Fixed-Effects models, Tree-based models, Time Series Forecasting, A/B & Multivariate Experimentation, Deep Learning, Multi-Armed Bandits
- **Engineering & MLOps:** Python, SQL, GCP (BigQuery, Vertex AI), VS Code, Docker, Kubernetes, Apache Airflow, CI/CD (GitLab), Jira, Model Deployment & Monitoring.
- **Business & Leadership:** Promotional & Pricing Optimization, Product Roadmap & Growth Strategy, SVP-level Stakeholder Management, Store Operations, Mentorship & Resource Allocation

EDUCATION

Purdue University, West Lafayette, USA - *M.S. Business Analytics and Information Management* December 2021
Birla Institute of Technology and Science, Pilani, India - *B.E. (Hons.), Electronics and Instrumentation* July 2017

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Kohl's Inc. Dallas, TX
Manager, Data Science & Research January 2026 – Present

- **Real-Time Incentives Engine:**
 - Spearheaded **four** data scientists to deploy a Real-Time incentives engine and delivered **\$55M** incremental revenue by identifying offer-sensitive website visitors via **Causal ML** uplift models with Qini AUC $\approx 4\%$.
 - Designed a hybrid serving architecture, integrating **Vertex AI endpoint** for logged-out visitors and **Bigtable** batch serving for logged-in users.
- **Store-Labor Allocation Tool:**
 - Led a team of **three** data scientists to architect an end-to-end labor optimization tool, delivering a **7.5%** MAPE (370 bps reduction w.r.t legacy forecast) via a Temporal Fusion Transformer (**TFT**) architecture for store-day sales forecasts.
 - Productionized **bi-weekly** model refreshes through **Vertex AI** pipelines and integrated forecasts into a **Streamlit** allocation tool for shift planning, resulting in a **18%** reduction in understaffing and a **12%** reduction in overtime.
- **Store Conversion Attribution:**
 - Architected a **causal discovery** framework across **1,100+** stores using Double Machine Learning (**DML**) and **ALE** curves to quantify the impact of **key drivers** on store conversion.
 - Automated **quarterly** model refreshes through **Vertex AI** pipelines for seasonal drivers, enabling store operations to reallocate **\$20M** in operational spend to **high-conversion** drivers in **Q4 2025**.

Staff Data Scientist January 2022 – Dec 2025

- **Kohl's Cash Gift Targeting:**
 - Developed a **T-Learner** uplift framework to optimize marketing budget allocation via **Marginal ROI** (mROI) maximization for lapsed customer re-engagement.
 - Increased campaign efficiency from **1.3x** to **2.0x mROI** and productionized **Vertex AI pipelines** for monthly scoring of **20M+** customers, delivering **\$40M** in annual incremental sales.
- **Dynamic Pricing System:**
 - Developed a pricing engine using **XGBoost** and **ALEs** to capture price elasticity across **50k+ Styles** and **500k+ SKUs**.
 - Engineered **Vertex AI Pipelines** to automate monthly model refreshes and batch deployment, delivering optimized price points and elasticity coefficients directly to downstream engineering teams via **BigQuery**.
- **Experimentation Design Platform:**
 - Built a simulation-driven Streamlit application and deployed it on **OpenShift** to automate A/B and multivariate test design.
 - Integrated power analysis and sensitivity simulations to optimize sample allocation under budget constraints, **reducing test planning latency from days to minutes** and increasing enterprise experimentation velocity.

EXL Service Bengaluru, India
Senior Data Scientist September 2017 – November 2020

- **Broadcasting Analytics:**
 - Engineered high-precision regression models (**Adj-R² ≈ 0.92**) to identify structural viewership drivers, providing the executive team with actionable insights into audience behavior
 - Leveraged viewership insights to steer a **\$30M broadcaster contract negotiation**, providing the data-driven evidence required for executive-level valuation and risk mitigation
- **Customer Retention Framework:**
 - Developed a predictive **churn-propensity** framework to identify at-risk customers over a 3-month horizon.
 - Designed and implemented targeted retention strategies that reduced churn by **8%** over **15 months**, significantly increasing Customer Lifetime Value and long-term retention.
- **Fan-Base Behavioral Segmentation:**
 - Applied advanced **clustering techniques** to architect multi-dimensional audience profiles across merchandise, **fantasy sports**, and ticketing behaviors.
 - Delivered an actionable segmentation framework that powered **personalized marketing** campaigns, resulting in a **4%** increase in merchandise purchases and ticket revenue.

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Achieved **Dean's List** and **Beta Gamma Sigma** honors for academic excellence at Purdue University, 2021
- Member of Purdue's **Krannert Net Impact** (KNI) club to bring social inclusiveness to businesses, 2021
- EXL ORION **Hackathon** Finalist, 2019; EXL Shining Star Award, 2018
- Led undergraduate **cricket team** to an **88%** win rate over 19 games, securing a **championship** title, 2016